

A GUIDE TO A BETTER WORKLIFE

CONTACT US

Call **UNISON DIRECT**
on **0800 0 857 857**

or visit **www.lasunison.com**



ABOUT LAS UNISON

- The Largest Ambulance branch in the Country.
- The Largest Health Branch in London.
- Part of the largest Trade Union in the country with over 1.3 Million members.

OUR MEMBERS DO MANY DIFFERENT JOBS

We are all Frontline

- Operational Road Staff
- Control Room Staff
- Scheduling and
- Resource Staff
- Fleet Technicians
- IM&T Staff
- Administrative Staff
- Make Ready
- Private Ambulance Sector
- Education Centres

**DID
YOU
KNOW?**

WHY HAVE OVER 4000 MEMBERS ALREADY DECIDED TO JOIN LAS UNISON

- ✓ To receive advice and support in their employment
- ✓ Because they want fair and equal treatment
- ✓ To gain security of employment
- ✓ Because they want to be treated with dignity in the workplace

KEY FACTS

- ✓ We are the largest Trade Union in Britain
- ✓ We campaign and lobby on key issues affecting our members and the public at large
- ✓ We work to protect and improve the public services
- ✓ We aim to win equal pay and employment rights for everyone
- ✓ We aim to improve safety in the workplace
- ✓ We aim to end discrimination and harassment at work
- ✓ We win compensation for members
- ✓ The NHS came from the union movement
- ✓ Pensions were gained by the union movement
- ✓ People who came together to form the union – gave us most of the rights we take for granted today

150 years ago young children were being sent up chimneys to work, workers worked up to 15 hours each day 7 days a week, holidays were practically non-existent, sick and maternity pay was unheard of, and workers had few rights.

Trade unions have improved our lives by:

- Improving work safety
- Raising our standard of living
- Fighting and winning the right to public education for children
- Reducing the hours in a working week
- Introducing maternity pay and sick pay
- Improved our holidays
- Equal Pay for Women
- Fighting against Discrimination

WHAT IS A TRADE UNION?

A trade union is a voluntary association of workers, run by workers, to protect their interests and rights at work. Over 5 million workers in the UK belong to a trade union.

In the workplace, trade unions negotiate on behalf of their members using the collective strength of their membership to ensure fair pay and decent working conditions.

Trade unions provide representation ensuring that individual workers are treated fairly by employers.

Trade union members can get free legal representation through their union in respect of injury at work or an infringement of their employment rights.

At national level trade unions lobby government to protect workers rights on issues like pensions and health and safety.

Trade unions negotiate better terms and conditions for the workers they represent. Government figures show, on average, trade union members earn 19% more than other employees.

SHOULD I JOIN A TRADE UNION?

YES YES YES... it's a balance of power. It's a NUMBERS GAME. Even if you are not active in the union (a representative or steward, or take part in running your branch) just being a member really counts.

Trade unions can provide workers with representation whether they are full or part time, and across all types of jobs and all types of employment. All sorts of workers can join, including agency workers and migrant workers. All workers have a legal right to join a trade union.

By not joining you make trade unions weaker, your employer stronger and undermine our ability to fight for fair treatment and equality and protect workers in the workplace.

EXTRA BENEFITS OF UNISON

- Home, Travel & Pet Insurance
- Health & Dental Plans
- Eye Care
- Holidays
- Energy Price Comparison Service
- Motor Insurance
- Financial & Debt Advice
- Shopping Discounts & Cashback
- LAS UNISON Book Grant

WHAT CAN WE DO FOR YOU?

- ✓ We offer unrivalled protection and representation at work
- ✓ We fight for pay and conditions of service
- ✓ We help with Health & Safety guidance and support
- ✓ UNISON direct: The first union call centre which provides you with help and advice at the end of the phone
- ✓ We offer online employment and work advice

WHAT HAVE TRADE UNIONS DONE FOR US?

- ✓ Health and Safety
- ✓ Holidays
- ✓ Weekends
- ✓ Minimum wage
- ✓ Equal Pay
- ✓ Anti-discrimination laws
- ✓ Pensions at work
- ✓ The right not to be unfairly dismissed
- ✓ Parental & Maternity Leave



Across the whole sector, UNISON members are there, supporting each other and speaking up for people like you.